

Strategic reversal of mates

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Reciprocally changed mates for two chosen black defences are plenty in two-movers using a wide range of mechanisms which never seem to deplete with passage of time. In the problems in this article mate reversal occur after two defences by a single black piece.

Uri Avner

First HM, To Mat 1955-56



Mate in two moves

The first example is from Israeli maestro Uri Avner's book 'Close encounters with the chess pieces'. The set mates are 1...d6 2.Nc6 (A); 1...d5 2.Bd4 (B). The key is 1.Nf6! (2.Bd6). The defence motives of the BPd7 i.e interference and self-block are also cleverly reciprocated.

1...d6 2.Bd4 (B); 1...d5 2.Nc6 (A)

The subtle key produces lot of effects like opening of BBh1 line, closing of BRh6 line, unguarding d6 and placing additional guard on d6. The by play is 1...Rxf6 2.Qg3; 1...Rc8 2.Nxd7 and 1..Bd5 2.Rxd5; 1..Nxf5 2.Qxf5

The second twower below is a Forsberg twin require keen study of BPe7 which closes the lines of white bishops. In each phase there is a set Gamage unpin and the key

determines one of the two ways of guarding c2 threatening Bc4.

I 2.Qd7(A) There is wealth of strategy in this reciprocal change. 1. Na3? fails to 1...e5 in the diagram as WQ cannot unpin BB and for similar reason in b) 1.Na1? fails to 1...e6!(2.Qd7?)

Wieland Bruch

3 prize, Schach-report 1992



Mate in two moves b) BRf5

The problem for solving (below) presents a combination of reciprocal change and mate transference in an elegant setting.

Y.Retter

First prize, Israel Ring Ty 1955



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'The rook cross': Solution to problem for solving in the article "The rook cross": 'Key 1.Qh4! waiting 1...N any 2.Ne2; 1...Rxd5 1.exd5; 1...Rxe6 2.e5; 1...Rxf5 2.exf5 and 1...Rxe4 2.Qxe4

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